



A Clean Continuation Short

A real trade breakdown: the thesis, the stop-out, the re-entry, and two more setups from the same session

SIRES × ETHOS ORDER FLOW



\$870 ON THE DAY • REAL ORDER TICKETS • 3 SETUPS • 14 PAGES

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Being honest about variance

why this trade, and why not every week looks like this one

This is a full trade breakdown of a continuation short: the pre-market thesis, the entry triggers, a stop-out, the re-entry, and two more setups from the same session. On the day, this account closed up \$870 across two trades, close to a payout.

Worth stating plainly, in his own words: the previous two and a half weeks on this account were roughly break even sliding into losing, real negative variance, not a highlight reel. The rest of his funded accounts were up only around \$1,000 combined over that stretch. This is the one account genuinely in profit right now. He's shown winning streaks before, a four week run and an 18k payout, and he's shown losing streaks too, live, in front of mentorship members. This trade gets shown because of how clean the read was, not because every week looks like this.

Why this matters for how you read the rest of this document. Every setup below worked. That is not the norm, it's the reason this particular session was worth breaking down in this much depth.

04 The 5 minute thesis

a minor volume node, and negative Delta stacking against the level

On the 5 minute, price had displaced lower and value had shifted down with it. Once price found balance, a minor volume node stood out as the level to use, a place used previously, multiple times, as resistance. In terms of Delta, negative Delta was stacking and stacking into that level, and cross-checked against the DOM and heat map, a clear pattern of sellers pinning the level.

That combination, a real minor volume node plus visibly stacking negative Delta into it, was the read: be lenient on sellers here, expect buyers to be absorbed and exhausted, and treat this as a good area for price to come back into balance from. He also names this level a failed auction at the top, the wicks that never actually closed and held above it.

THE 5 MINUTE THESIS: MINOR VOLUME NODE, NEGATIVE DELTA STACKING



05 The AMT structure

an established balance, POC as fair value, and failed auctions at the top

With an established balance in place and POC treated as the area of fair value, the framework is simple to state: if price comes back to the top of that balance, the default expectation is shorts, unless price closes above it with real, extreme buying pressure. If that pressure shows up, the read flips to a retest and longs back toward the session's VWAP instead.

The areas marked here are failed auctions, in his words, more than once: price wicking above the level without ever truly closing and holding there. One of those wicks, worked on a lower timeframe like the 40 range or 1 minute, would have been good for roughly three to four R on its own, before price came back down.

FAILED AUCTIONS AT THE TOP: WICKS THAT NEVER CLOSED AND HELD



Why the exit wasn't POC

consistency rules, and reading a gamma long environment for chop risk

The exit on this trade came off a transition in established value, not off POC, even though POC would also have worked as a valid take profit. The reason is deliberately not a pure order flow reason: consistency rules on a funded account, and the regime context for the week.

For the prior week and a half, the market had mostly been sitting in a gamma long environment, which raises the odds of chop rather than a clean move all the way to the lower extreme. Taking the safer, closer exit reflected that risk rather than assuming this session would behave like a trend day. The two sessions immediately before this one had been in a negative gamma environment instead, which lines up with why price dropped and dumped into this balance in the first place.

The higher timeframe: yearly composite

a low participation zone, sliced through, then used as resistance again

Zooming out to the yearly composite, the level in play sat at an area of low participation, a zone price had previously sliced straight through rather than idled inside. Higher timeframe low volume nodes behave in one of two ways: price stalls and tries to build balance there, or, if there's enough selling pressure, it slices straight through. The Delta on that slice showed sellers clearly showing their hand, and price fully dumped through it.

From there, price arrived at a yearly composite balance area, again with a nearby zone of low participation. The same previous balance from earlier in the session got touched again and used again as resistance to push price back down, slicing through the same low volume area a second time.

THE YEARLY COMPOSITE: LOW PARTICIPATION, SLICED THROUGH TWICE



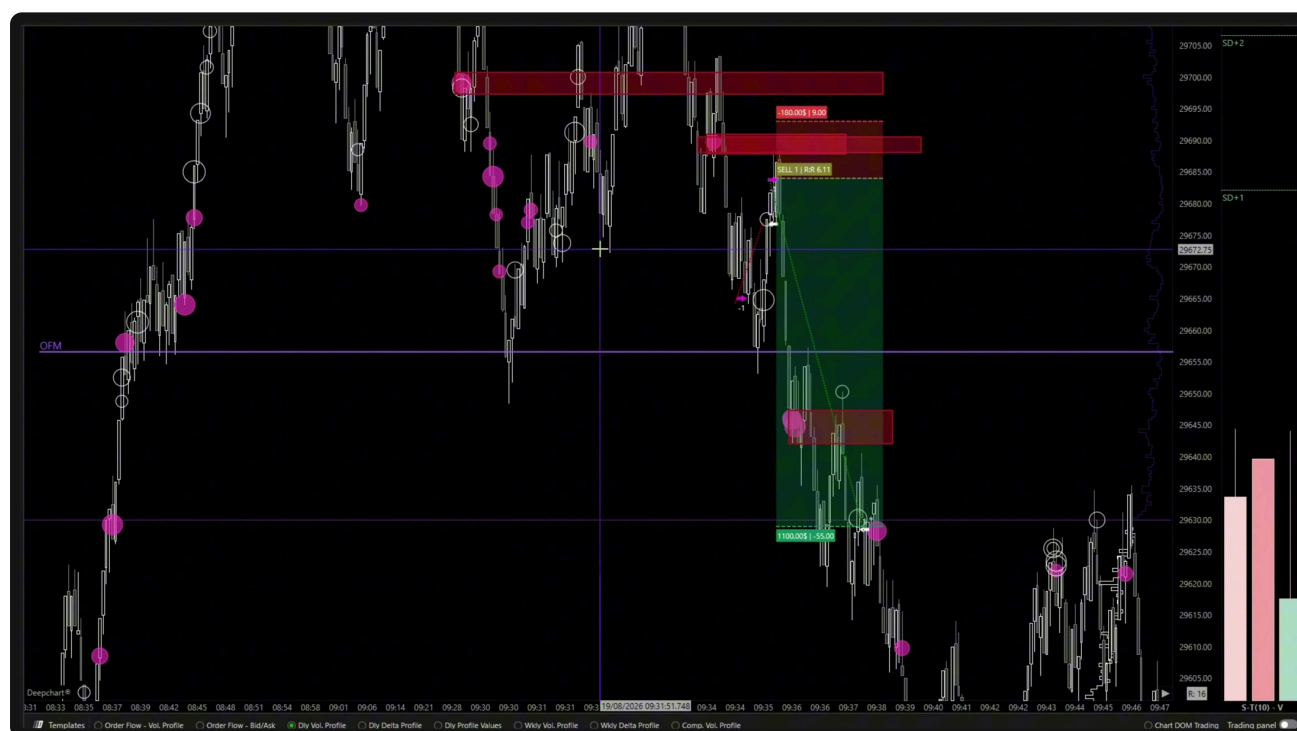
The refill zone, repeated

why the first entry stopped out, and why the second one held

The first attempt at this short got stopped out. The read going in was that buyers who had previously controlled the push higher would offer a passive refill zone for sellers, a place to drive price back down from. Buyers came back in instead, and the trade got stopped, which he's plain about: that's fine, it happens.

What made the re-entry worth taking was that the same level kept behaving the same way on repeat. Sellers had control, price went lower. Price came back up to the level, sellers had control again. It went lower again. Sellers had had control there before, more than once, which is exactly what a refill zone is: a level where the same side keeps winning the argument. Buyers had controlled the push up, but the level itself kept refilling back to sellers, which is what the re-entry was built on.

THE RE-ENTRY: SELL 1, R:R 6.11, TARGET \$1,100 AGAINST A \$180 STOP



Real order ticket from the trade, not a reconstruction. R:R and dollar figures are read directly off it.

Multi-timeframe alignment

the dealing range VP lining POC up with the same refill zone

Going back over the trade afterward, drawing out the volume profile for the actual dealing range in play showed the resistance used for the refill zone lined up with POC on that leg, on the 1 minute. That's an intraday alignment on top of the higher timeframe read already covered: the refill zone and the dealing range's own fair value were the same price.

He's clear that this alignment wasn't something checked in real time during the trade, it's something confirmed afterward, shown here because it's the kind of detail that makes a trade this clean actually explainable rather than a lucky guess. The setup overall: a balance rejection. Price came out of balance, used the level as resistance, pushed all the way back down, and that was a failed auction with buyers absorbed the whole way down.

Reading dealing range alignment like this, live, is part of what gets walked through inside the mentorship.

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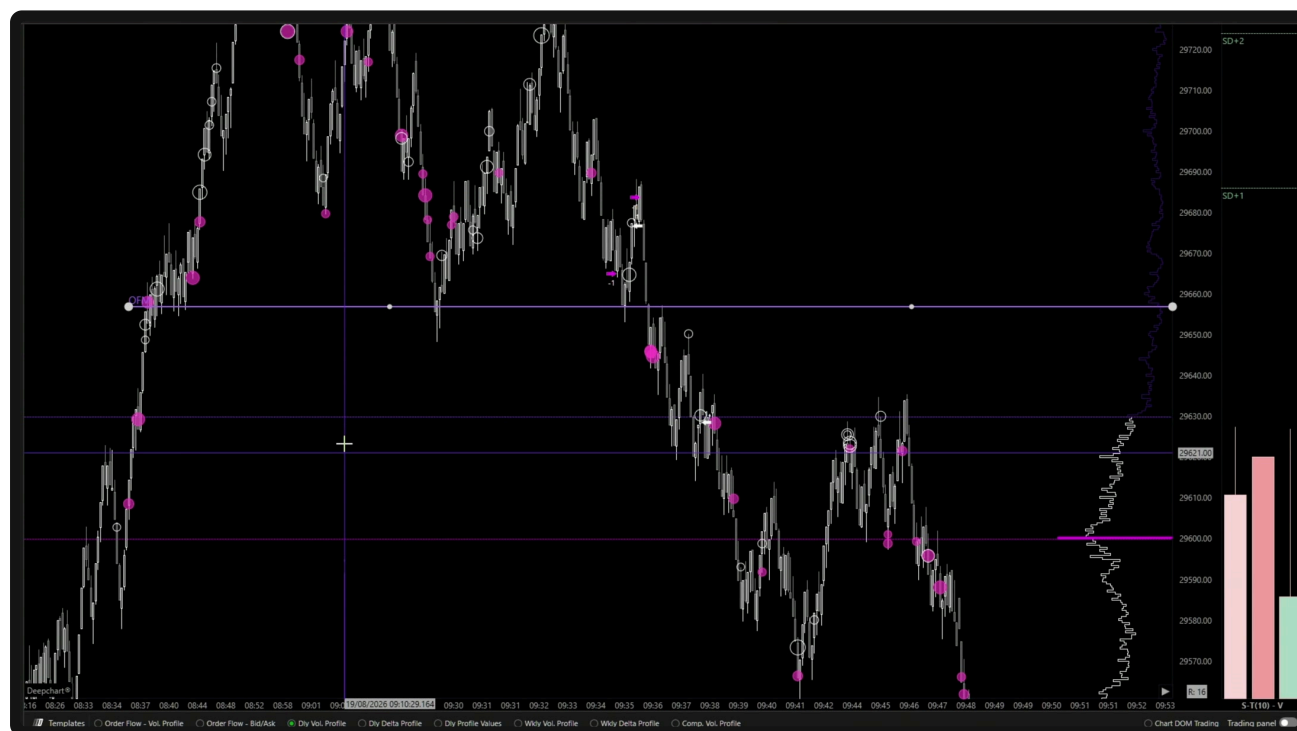
The second trade: origin of the move, retaken

a failed squeeze, a refill zone, then sellers show up again

A second good trade from the same session came from retaking shorts at an origin of the move. Sellers showed their hand first, willing to price lower, which is what a genuine origin of the move entry needs: initiative, not just a guess. Taken there directly, it would have been a high risk entry, since the squeeze lower hadn't actually confirmed yet.

Price came back up instead, into a refill zone where sellers had already shown control, effectively top-ticking there. From that point, sellers came back in with even more aggression than the first attempt, confirming that control was back with them despite the earlier failed squeeze. Price moved back toward intraday daily value, buyers hit the wall on the way and got absorbed, and that's the re-entry point, stop placed right there. Target: back to where sellers previously had no control, or more conservatively, the current intraday POC.

THE ORIGIN OF THE MOVE MARKED (OFM), BIG TRADES SHOWING THE AGGRESSION BEHIND IT



The third setup: a squeeze with no failure

the cleanest version of the same idea, no retry needed

A third setup from the session is worth separating from the second: this one is actually a squeeze, not an origin of the move, because it never failed the way the second trade's first attempt did. Sellers showed willingness to price lower and the move happened fast, with real aggression, no retest, no false start.

Once buyers hit that move and got absorbed, the entry is available with a tight stop right there, opposition visibly failing on both sides of the read at once. This is the same underlying model taught in the mentorship for catching continuation entries, whether that's framed as a squeeze, an origin of the move, or an earlier entry inside the same idea.

Why these were all the same trade

filtering continuation entries against one higher timeframe bias

All three setups in this document are continuation trades, and that's not a coincidence, it's the filter. The higher timeframe thesis was short from the open, so every entry taken had to agree with that bias before it was considered at all. A clean squeeze in the opposite direction would have been ignored, not because the read was wrong on its own terms, but because it disagreed with the higher timeframe context already established.

That's the actual throughline of this whole session: one higher timeframe thesis, three separate lower timeframe confirmations that all pointed the same direction, at different points in the day. None of the three needed a new idea. Each one needed the same idea to show up again.

The checklist

every rule in this document, printable

THE THESIS

- ☐ I have a real minor or low volume node, not an arbitrary level, confirmed by Delta stacking against it.
- ☐ I know the higher timeframe balance and where POC sits as fair value before I look for an entry.

MANAGING THE TRADE

- ☐ My exit reflects the actual gamma regime for the week, not an assumption that today is a trend day.
- ☐ I'm respecting my own consistency rules over squeezing every last point out of a winner.

THE REFILL ZONE

- ☐ I can point to the same side winning control at this level more than once, not just once.
- ☐ A stop-out at this level doesn't disqualify a re-entry if the level's behavior hasn't actually changed.

CONTINUATION ENTRIES

- ☐ Every entry I take agrees with my higher timeframe bias, not just the setup in isolation.
- ☐ I know whether this is a squeeze (no failure) or an origin of the move re-entry (after a failed squeeze), and I'm not treating them as identical.

One thesis. Three confirmations, same direction.

Not every week looks like this one, and this document says so upfront. What it shows instead is what a session looks like when a higher timeframe thesis holds up against three separate lower timeframe tests: a stop-out that gets correctly re-entered, an origin of the move that fails once and confirms on the second attempt, and a squeeze that never needed a second attempt at all.

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Companion reading: Your Mistakes With Absorption, and Reading Delta, both free at kanji.org.uk.

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